CampusLoop: Product Requirements Document

Minor Project, Product Management | Cluelearn Industrial Training and Internship | Version 1.0 | November 2026 | Author: Anas Anjum

1. Overview

Product: CampusLoop, campus-only exchange where verified students buy, sell and donate used items.

Vision: A trusted campus-only exchange where students buy, sell and donate used items, so nothing useful ends up in the trash.

Platform: Mobile-first app (iOS and Android, or mobile web for the MVP).

Status: Early discovery research is complete: survey (n=13), two student interviews, eight low-fidelity wireframes and a clickable prototype. Further validation is needed.

2. Problem Statement

College students acquire textbooks, electronics and room essentials, then stop needing them. There is no easy, trusted way to pass these items to other students on campus, so they are kept idle, thrown away, or sold informally.

Evidence from the survey (n=13):

- 67% of respondents with unused items kept them idle or threw them away. Only 25% sold or donated them.
- Textbooks and study materials were the most common unused item (55%).
- 100% of respondents use no platform today to buy or sell used items.
- Finding reliable buyers or sellers was the top problem (33%).
- Student ID verification was the top trust feature (54%), followed by in-app chat (31%) and pickup spots (15%).
- 92% want to buy, sell and donate in one place.

Interview evidence:

- **No trusted place to buy:** Students said they have no reliable platform to buy second-hand items in good condition without worrying about fraud.

- **No clear place to sell study material:** Students said they don't know where to sell their notes and used study material online, which especially affects beginner students.

Opportunity: Give students a simple, verified, campus-only place to exchange items, with donation built in to reduce waste.

3. Goals and Non-Goals

Goals

1. Help students exchange used items easily within their campus.
2. Build trust through campus verification.
3. Reduce reusable items that get discarded.
4. Validate demand with a lean MVP before adding features.

Non-goals (not in MVP)

Payments, delivery, seller ratings, cross-campus listings, and an admin dashboard.

4. Target Users

Primary user: College students, including day scholars, who want affordable items or want to pass on things they no longer need. Our survey respondents were mostly first-year day scholars.

Key needs: Find reliable buyers and sellers, feel safe, save time, and avoid waste.

Secondary user: Final-year and hostel students moving out, who have many items to pass on at once. Hostel residents were only 1 of 13 respondents, so this group needs more research.

5. Competitive Landscape

The comparison below summarizes each alternative·s strengths and limitations, along with the opportunity for CampusLoop.

Alternative	Strengths	Weaknesses	Gap for CampusLoop
OLX	Large audience, many categories	Spam risk, no campus filter	Campus-only trust
Facebook Marketplace	Easy to use, existing profiles	Scams, no verification	Verified students
Quikr	Wide reach	Cluttered, general purpose	Focused experience
Campus WhatsApp or Telegram groups	Free, trusted community	Messages get buried, no search	Structure and search
Doing nothing (keep or discard)	No effort	Wastes money and items	Easy exchange and donation

6. Scope and Release Plan

Release	Features
MVP	Verified sign-up, create listing, donate option, search and filter, item details, contact seller, mark as sold or given, report listing
V2	In-app chat, favorites, on-campus meetup suggestions
V3	Impact tracker, seller ratings

7. User Stories and Prioritization

Scoring uses RICE: (Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort. Reach is 1 to 10, Impact is 3, 2, 1 or 0.5, Confidence is a percentage, and Effort is 1 to 5. Scores are estimates and should be adjusted to your own judgment.

Rank	Story	RICE	Release
1	US4: As a buyer, I want to see photos, condition and seller info, so I can decide before contacting	20.0	MVP
2	US6: As a student leaving, I want to donate items for free, so they get reused	9.6	MVP
3	US2: As a seller, I want to post an item with photos and price, so buyers find it	9.0	MVP
4	US1: As a student, I want to sign up with my student ID or college email, so only students join	8.0	MVP
5	US3: As a buyer, I want to search and filter, so I find items fast	7.2	MVP
6	US9: As a seller, I want to mark an item as sold, so people stop asking	6.0	MVP
7	US5: As a buyer, I want to message the seller in the app, so I don't share my number	3.2	V2
8	US12: As a user, I want to report suspicious listings, so the platform stays safe	2.4	MVP (basic)
9	US8: As a user, I want to pick a safe campus meetup spot, so exchanges feel secure	2.0	V2
10	US11: As a buyer, I want to save favorites, so I can check them later	1.6	V2
11	US10: As an eco-conscious student, I want to see items I saved from landfill, so I stay motivated	1.25	V3
12	US7: As a buyer, I want to see seller ratings, so I can trust who I deal with	0.83	V3

Prioritization note: Verification (US1) scores lower than cheap features but is a gating requirement, since it was the top trust feature in the survey. Ratings are last because no re be reviewed as pilot evidence becomes available.

8. Functional Requirements (MVP) with Acceptance Criteria

F1. Verified sign-up (US1)

- Sign-up accepts only a valid college email or student ID.
- A verification step must be completed before the account is active.
- Invalid or non-college entries show a clear error message.

F2. Create listing (US2, US6)

- Title, category, condition and at least one photo are required.
- Price is optional when "Donate for free" is selected.
- The listing appears in search shortly after posting.

F3. Search and filter (US3)

- Search works by keyword.
- Filters work for category, price range, condition and free items.
- Zero results show suggestions rather than a blank screen.

F4. Item details (US4)

- Shows photos, description, condition, price, posted date, seller's verified badge and area.
- Seller phone numbers are never shown.

F5. Contact seller

- A contact action is available from the listing page.
- Contact details are not exposed publicly.

F6. Mark as sold or given (US9)

- Sold or given items disappear from search.
- The seller can relist an item if the exchange falls through.

F7. Report listing (US12)

- A report button appears on every listing.
- Reported listings are flagged for review.

9. Non-Functional Requirements

Area	Requirement (proposed)
Performance	Search results in under 3 seconds on a normal mobile connection
Privacy	Collect minimal data and show no personal contact details publicly
Security	Access limited to verified students, with a report flow for abuse
Usability	A new user can post a listing in about 2 minutes, with touch targets of 44px or more
Accessibility	Readable contrast and labelled buttons and inputs
Ethics	No dark patterns or misleading claims

10. Design

Eight low-fidelity wireframes cover the core flow: welcome and verify, home, search and categories, item details, create listing, contact seller (MVP), my listings and profile. In-app chat is planned for V2. A clickable prototype covers the key flows. Link:

Open the CampusLoop clickable prototype

11. Success Metrics

North Star metric: Items exchanged or donated per week.

Supporting KPIs

1. Verified sign-ups per week.
2. Share of listings that end in an exchange or donation.
3. 4-week retention of active users.

Proposed pilot targets (first four weeks; planning assumptions, not actual results):
North Star: 2-3 completed exchanges or donations per week by the end of week 4.
Verified sign-ups: 5 new verified students per week.
Listing completion: at least 25% of published listings marked sold or given within 30 days.
Four-week retention: at least 20%.

12. Go-to-Market Summary

- **Positioning:** A trusted, campus-only way to buy, sell and donate used items.
- **Pricing:** Free for students at launch. Revenue is out of scope for the MVP.
- **Launch channels:** Class and hostel groups, college social pages, student clubs, and a semester-end giveaway drive.
- **Launch risk:** Too few listings at the start. Seed the app with items from early adopters before opening it widely.

13. Risks and Assumptions

- Survey interest was mixed (average 3.0 out of 5), so demand needs further validation.
- The survey sample is small (n=13) and mostly first-year day scholars, so findings are indicative only.
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  - Only 3 of 13 respondents (23.1%) had bought a used item in the prior year.
  - Further research should explore current exchange channels and barriers.
  - Trust and safety depend on a clear verification and reporting process.

14. Open Questions

1. Which verification method will the campus accept: student ID, college email, or both?
2. What is the safest MVP contact method while keeping students' personal details private?
3. How will reported listings be reviewed, and by whom?

15. Timeline

Date	Milestone
5 to 6 Nov	Research and competitor analysis
7 Nov	Prioritization and wireframes
8 Nov	Prototype, PRD and roadmap
9 Nov	Metrics, GTM, report and deck
10 Nov	Final check and submission

References

- **RICE framework:** Intercom, RICE: Simple prioritization for product managers
- **OLX:** About OLX India and OLX app listing on the App Store
- **Quikr:** Quikr official site and Quikr profile on Indian Retailer